

Film tourism and destination marketing: The case of *Captain Corelli's Mandolin*

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ABSTRACT

KEYWORDS: *film tourism, destination marketing, tourism impacts*

Film tourism is a growing phenomenon worldwide. However, many tourism organizations have been slow to tap the potential benefits of film tourism, perhaps due to a lack of knowledge, research, or evidence that explains the potential of film tourism. This article presents a conceptual

framework for understanding the film tourism phenomenon and, then, using a case study method, reports on the tourism impacts of Captain Corelli's Mandolin on the Island of Cephalonia in Greece. The case supports previous research claiming that films can have a powerful influence on travel decisions. It also shows that film tourism is not always directly related to the success of a film or the marketing activities of Destination Marketing Organizations. Implications for destination marketers are discussed.

INTRODUCTION

The study of film tourism is relatively new in tourism research. Sometimes called movie-induced or film-induced tourism, film tourism is defined here as tourist visits to a destination or attraction as a result of the destination being featured on television, video, DVD or the cinema screen. Falling loosely under the umbrella of cultural tourism, film tourism is a growing phenomenon worldwide. The benefits of film tourism are becoming increasingly apparent. Appealing to wide and diverse markets, destination marketers can use a film as a springboard for marketing campaigns if the film is seen as an appropriate fit for the destination. Marketing opportunities are generated when the film is being premiered and distributed as well as during each release window. Additional businesses and services can be created through film tourism that in turn can en-

courage the extension and strengthening of the visitor season.

The increase in film tourism is linked to both the rise in international travel and the history of film-making. It is more specifically associated with the development of the budget US blockbuster, starting with *Jaws* in 1975. Whereas *Jaws* opened in the USA in 465 screens, nearly 30 years later *The Lord of the Rings* opened in 10,000 screens worldwide, reflecting the dramatic rise in cinema attendance over the years. A typical movie with international distribution can now reach over one hundred million consumers as it moves from box office, to video/DVD to TV. Television series have also become dramatically effective in influencing the popularity of destinations. *Hawaiian Eye*, *Hawaii 5-0* and *Magnum* did wonders to boost Hawaii as a place to visit in the 1980s and 1990s, and more recently, 20th Century Fox's *North Shore*, NBC's *Hawaii*, and ABC's *Lost*, are attracting more tourists to the islands.

Unfortunately, many tourism organizations have been slow to tap the potential benefits of film tourism, perhaps due to a lack of knowledge, research, or evidence that explains the potential of film tourism. This article presents a conceptual framework for understanding the film tourism phenomenon and, then, using a case study method, reports on the tourism impact of *Captain Corelli's Mandolin* on the island of Cephalonia in Greece. Theoretical and practical implications are discussed.

UNDERSTANDING FILM TOURISM

There is no doubt that film-viewing influences travel decisions. A recent survey in the UK found that eight out of 10 Britons get their holiday destination ideas from films, and one in five will actually make the journey to the location of their favourite film.¹ Yet researchers do not have a clear understanding of why, and very few have explored the phenomenon in any detail.

Figure 1 is a conceptual framework for understanding film tourism. At the centre of the model is the film tourist who is motivated to visit a destination through push or

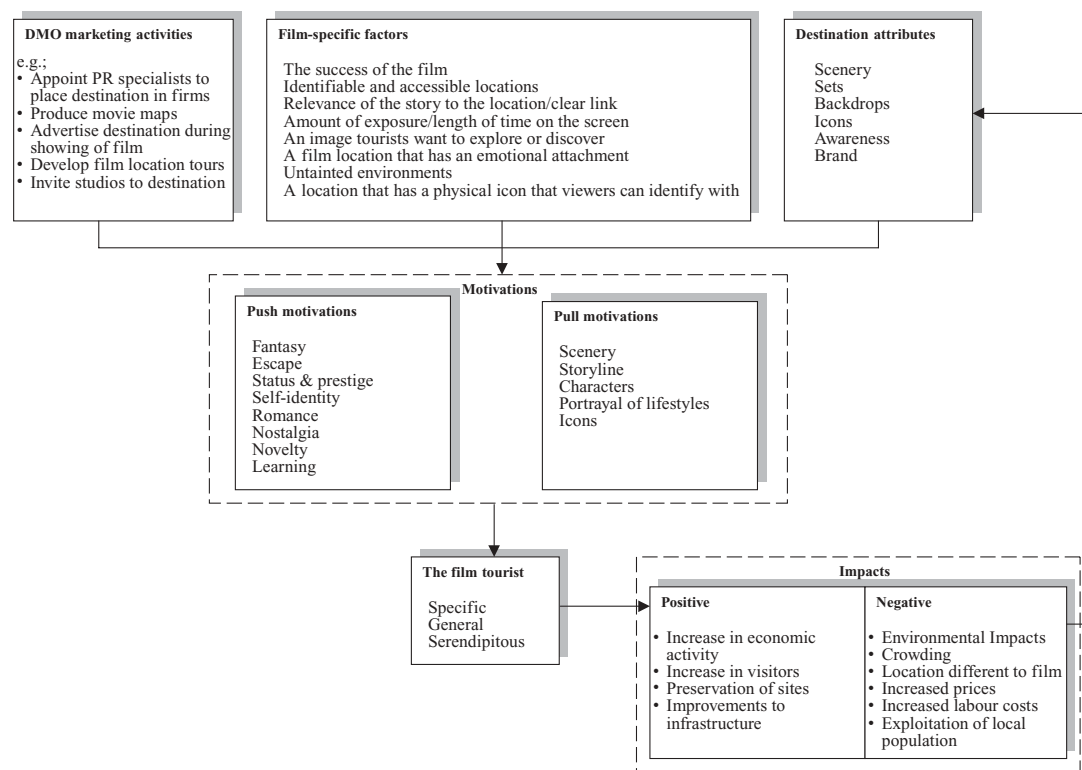
pull motives. In turn, these motives are inspired by one or more of three factors; destination marketing activities, film-specific factors, and the destination attributes. Film tourism has been shown to generate both positive and negative impacts, and in the model a feedback loop indicates that these impacts will in turn have an affect on the destination attributes. The model is now explained in more detail.

Film-specific factors

Certain films are likely to have more of a pull for tourists than others. Research has shown that film is a successful medium for tourism if the storyline and site are closely interrelated, and the film involves the audience in the story giving them an emotional experience, which they link with the location.² Repeat viewing gives further exposure resulting in greater familiarity, attachment and identification, all of which may result in a desire to visit looking for the sites, people, experiences and fantasies portrayed by the film.³ Films that reflect an authentic image of the destination, and capture the essence of a place, whether it is scenery or cultural content, tend to be more successful in attracting film tourists.⁴ *Crocodile Dundee* was used by Australia to foster wider international interest by reflecting both ancient and modern culture. Historical films also have a huge impact internationally.

Although there are exceptions, the success of a film can generally be used as a predictor of film tourism.⁵ For films outside the USA, success does afford tremendous opportunities for countries or regions to attract the lucrative US market as well as other overseas nationals. For example, *Out of Africa*, set in Kenya and Tanzania, has been credited with bringing American tourists back to the continent. Other critical factors affecting film tourism are the amount of exposure or length of time the location is on the screen, and crucially, the link has to be made successfully between the film and a location, such as *The Lord of the Rings* and New Zealand, *Braveheart* and Scotland, and *Crocodile Dundee* and Australia. In terms of expo-

Figure 1 A framework for understanding film tourism



sure, *The Lord of Rings* undoubtedly had such a strong effect on tourism because of its reach (over 100 million people have seen the films) and the fact that it was a trilogy.

Cohen has suggested a number of variables that will affect the impact of films on tourism.⁶ First of all, the setting of the film will affect the viewer's perception of a destination as a potential tour site. She suggests that the more the setting is in the foreground of the story, the more it will leave an impression on the viewer's mind. *Out of Africa*, referred to above, impresses upon the viewer the beauty and mystique of that country throughout the movie and therefore had a powerful impact on potential tourists. Another variable is how long and when the destination setting occurs in the movie. For example, in the movie *10*, Mexico was not featured throughout the movie, but the climax of the film occurred in Mexico and contributed towards Cancun becoming a major tourist site. Another factor that may

affect the impact of a film's setting deals with how explicit the setting is – the more explicit the setting the more effect it will have.

Destination marketing activities

According to Morgan and Pritchard, placing a destination in a film is the ultimate in tourism product placement.⁷ Film images persist for decades, provide publicity and create identities. The exposure a film gives a city, province or country is an advertisement viewed by potentially millions of people, an audience that could not be reached through specifically targeted tourism promotions. Destination Marketing Organizations (DMOs) can engage in a variety of marketing activities both before and after release of a film in order to leverage film tourism. Most destinations have a short-term focus that facilitates film production, concentrating on the associated economic impacts,⁸ but some are becoming active in

encouraging producers to make films in their region in order to benefit from the long-term tourism impacts. VisitBritain has been targeting Indian film producers for some time in the belief that they can be persuaded to use British locations for 'Bollywood' films, and, thereby, generate significant economic benefits for Britain's tourism industry.⁹ Even if the locations are used as backdrops for other countries, VisitBritain works very closely with film distributors and other partners on tactical promotions to ensure that attention is drawn to these British locations and maximum exposure is obtained. The Swiss Tourist Board is also active in encouraging Bollywood producers to film in its country.

A few destinations appoint public relations specialists to 'place' their regions in films. Canada and The Bahamas, for example, have identified film tourism as a marketing opportunity, and employ Weber Shandwick, one of the biggest PR firms in the world, to get them maximum exposure for their destinations in television and film.¹⁰ Chicago's Office of Film and Entertainment Industries has also successfully increased the number of films made in that city by employing a product placement specialist. However, these examples appear to be exceptions. Even in New Zealand, a recent survey found that most regions conduct little planning to maximize the impacts of film production, and that the post-production exposure impacts on image are not fully understood.¹¹

Collaborative campaigns with the film industry are a powerful way to induce film tourists.¹² DMOs are beginning to forge relationships with film commissions in order to track productions and film releases so they are in a position to act as soon as they see the signs of film tourism. Executives at VisitBritain attempt to plan with a studio at least 12 months in advance of release date. In The Bahamas, where the Film Commission is under the auspices of the Ministry of Tourism, the Ministry is involved immediately it receives a script. They invested US\$16 million on the recent film *After the Sunset* starring Pierce Brosnan in order to ensure maximum exposure for the island. The Aus-

tralian Tourism Commission (ATC) is also very proactive in forging relationships with the film industry. Recently, they collaborated with Disney on *Finding Nemo*, being the first DMO to try promotion through an animated film.

Movie maps have been found to be successful as part of a film tourism marketing campaign. VisitBritain produced its first movie map campaign in 1996, sponsored by Vauxhall. It featured 200 film and TV locations around Britain from 60 years of British film history, and quickly became its most successful printed product. It generated extensive media coverage, both at home and overseas, prompting people to discover different parts of Britain as they followed in the footsteps of their screen heroes.¹³ Other destinations that have produced movie maps for various film locations include Seattle, New York, Australia and Mississippi. Others have promoted movie maps and location guides for specific films. In 2004, Santa Barbara Conference and Visitors Bureau produced *Sideways – The Map*, a guide to the film locations of *Sideways* even before the film was released. Within weeks of the premiere, visitors eager to see the diners, hotels and wineries used in the film purchased 10,000 copies of the guide.

Other marketing activities can include guided tours and film walks, and a recent travel magazine listed 25 film tourism destinations with detailed information about tour packages developed just for film tourists.¹⁴ There are numerous examples of such tours: in California, a local tour company capitalized on the success of the movie *Sideways*, mentioned above, by creating a popular *Sideways* tour; even before the Nicolas Cage film *National Treasure* was released, the Washington DC tourism website was advertising a 'National Treasure Tour' – a self-guided tour that followed in the footsteps of the actor; Journey Latin America, a tour operator in the UK, pre-empted the film *Motorcycle Diaries* by organizing a three-week *Motorcycle Diaries* tour from Buenos Aires to Lima; after *Harry Potter*, several tour operators set up to show visitors around the many movie locations featured in the film; and the

James Bond films have spawned many imaginative packages from tour operators.

Destination attributes

Some destinations are more likely to encourage film tourists than others. It has been suggested that the ideal film location to inspire film tourists is a formula of idyllic or extraordinary landscape qualities, a unique social and cultural vantage point, and/or an image that tourists identify with and wish to explore or rediscover. The outstanding scenery in *The Lord of the Rings* movies was one of the main reasons people travelled to New Zealand after the film, according to an International Visitor Survey of 2003. Romania was chosen as the place to film Anthony Minghella's Civil War epic, *Cold Mountain*, because no part of America offered the same unspoilt beauty necessary to re-create 19th-century North Carolina.¹⁵

Icons are also important. If some part of a movie is extraordinary or captivating, it serves as an icon which viewers attach to a location shown in the movie. Icons, abstract or tangible, become the focal point for visitation and the associated location is tangible evidence of the icon. Examples of icons that have attracted film tourists are Devil's Tower in *Close Encounters*, and the baseball field in *Field of Dreams*.

Film tourist motivations

In 1990 Urry suggested that places are chosen to be gazed upon because of anticipation generated through a variety of non-tourist activities such as film and television.¹⁶ In the same year, Butler, in acknowledging that literature has been of tremendous significance in the development of tourist destinations, predicted that as people placed less importance on reading as a form of getting information about places, and relied more on the visual form of information to gain knowledge, movies, videos and television would become even more important.¹⁷ He also suggested that the importance of the visual image in determining or shaping images and visitation is probably as great as it is unstudied.

Some researchers have used the push and pull factor theory of motivation to present a framework in which to examine film tourism from a consumer perspective.¹⁸ Push factors are internal drivers such as the need for socialization, the need for escape, or simply the desire for a suntan. Other film tourists may be motivated by the externally driven pull factors derived from the screen. Macionis classifies these into three types – *Place* (location, attributes, landscapes, scenery), *Personality* (cast, characters, celebrity) and *Performance* (plot, theme, genre).

Riley and Van Doren¹⁹ likened major motion pictures to Ritchie's concept of 'hallmark' or special events.²⁰ These are major events of limited duration developed primarily to enhance the awareness of a destination. For motion pictures, the one departure from Ritchie's definition is the film producer's motivation for production. Movie-makers do not choose film settings in order to promote a destination; they do so as a compliment to the story. Riley and Van Doren asserted that the key for the construction of a favourable destination impression is a formula of idyllic or extraordinary landscape qualities, a unique social and cultural vantage point, and/or an image that tourists identify with and wish to explore or rediscover. Building on this work, Riley et al. added the ingredients of storyline themes, exciting sequences and human relationships, suggesting that films create exotic worlds that do not exist in reality but can be re-created through a visit to the location(s) where they were filmed.²¹ Through analysis of 12 location sites, they found that each location's allure is distinct, and that there are a wide range of reasons for visiting locations and an array of attractions that lure people. However, they do stress that the idea of icons is important. If some part of a movie is extraordinary or captivating, it serves as an icon which viewers attach to a location shown in the movie.

Film tourist typologies

Busby and Klug point out that there are several forms and characteristics of film tour-

ism.²² Film tourism may be part of a main holiday or may occur as the sole and main purpose out of special interest. It may occur for reasons of pilgrimage, escape and nostalgia or as part of the romantic gaze. A film location may be an attraction in its own right, or film tourism may take place where the filming is only believed to have taken place.

Macionis recently developed a continuum of film-induced tourism motivation which ranges from the specific film tourist to the general film tourist to the serendipitous film tourist.²³ A specific film tourist is one who actively seeks out places that they have seen in a film, whereas the general film tourist is not specifically drawn to a film location, but participates in film tourism activities while at the destination. The serendipitous film tourist just happens to be in a destination portrayed in a film.

Impacts

Some researchers have studied the impact of specific films on tourist visitation. Riley and Van Doren cite several cases in the USA where films have had a significant impact on tourism;²⁴ Tooke and Baker²⁵ and Grihault²⁶ both present four cases, the findings clearly demonstrating that the films studied caused an increase in visitor numbers at the film locations; Croy and Walker show how the effects of films on visitor numbers in predominantly rural and natural areas have in some cases been immense;²⁷ Cousins and Anderek provide evidence from two regions in North Carolina showing that film can have significant impact on locations used as movie settings;²⁸ and Busby et al. give numerous examples of destinations that have seen increases in tourist numbers following the release of films made in their region.²⁹ Although it must be acknowledged that the measurement of film tourism presents a number of difficulties, it is clear from this body of literature, that film and television can have a very positive impact on tourism visits.

In general, an increase in visitor numbers can only benefit a local economy. One of the major economic benefits and factors of film tourism is that viewing film locations

can often be an all-year, all-weather attraction, thus alleviating problems of seasonality.³⁰ Due to their association with fame, buildings and streets that were formerly considered commonplace and ordinary, suddenly acquire interest, status and ambience. Also, both films and television have a wide socioeconomic appeal, potentially broadening the base of the visitor market.³¹ One of the interesting aspects of film tourism is that it can be enduring. A film can continue to draw visitors year after year. Riley et al. found that although the peak of interest comes after a film is released, a 54 per cent increase in visitation was evident at least five years later in the 12 films they studied, and images are often retained for a long time.³² These enduring effects would explain the success of some destinations that have redeveloped locations to make film connections more apparent, and boosted tourism even when the film is not new.³³

However, there are a range of potential drawbacks to film tourism. Riley et al. say that even before release of a film, prices may have been driven up by the influx of production crews.³⁴ When the tourists do arrive, Beeton suggests that by creating a new, intrusive style of tourism, the traditional budget holiday-maker is disenfranchised.³⁵ Tooke and Baker propose that very often the film location will not have the carrying capacity to cope with large increases in visitors.³⁶ This could result in a number of possible undesirable consequences such as loss of privacy and local facilities for locals, increased vehicle traffic, and pedestrian congestion. The destruction of the natural environment is also a concern. For example, the beach on the Thai island used in the film *The Beach* was bulldozed, widened, and much of the native vegetation removed.³⁷ Another problem that could occur is when the location appears different to how it is portrayed in the film, resulting in a loss of visitor satisfaction.³⁸

OBJECTIVES AND METHOD

The main objective of this study therefore was to add to the body of film tourism

research by presenting a case study of a film and its tourism impacts, in order to both validate theory and to provide practical advice to destination marketers. A case study methodology³⁹ with a multi-method approach⁴⁰ was used for this study. Case studies offer depth and comprehensiveness for understanding a specific phenomenon, enabling inductive and rich description. Case research is specifically welcome in new situations where little is known about the phenomenon and in situations where current theories seem inadequate.⁴¹ Primary data was collected through in-depth interviews with Cephalonian tourist officials and business owners, and with tour operators from the UK. These interviews were conducted during the summer of 2004. Secondary data was also collected related to the film and its impacts, and content analysis was conducted on film reviews, tourist guides, articles about the island, destination promotional material, statistical documents related to tourist arrivals, and local newspaper articles.

CASE STUDY: THE IMPACT OF CAPTAIN CORELLI'S MANDOLIN ON TOURISM IN CEPHALONIA

With an area of 781 sq. km. and 254 km. of coastline, Cephalonia is the largest Greek Island in the Ionian Sea. Although local products include honey, pralines, white wine and quince paste, tourism is by far the largest export. In 1992, the writer Louis de Bernières bought a two-week package holiday to Cephalonia, and it was on this holiday that de Bernières, a former soldier, received his inspiration for the novel *Captain Corelli's Mandolin*. Instead of relaxing on the beach he spent his holiday learning about the island's history, and his resulting book tells the emotional story of a young Italian army officer sent to Cephalonia during World War II and his relationships with the locals, his fellow soldiers and German commanders. Publicity for the island reached fever pitch in the summer of 2001 with the release of the movie based on the book, starring Nicolas Cage as Corelli and co-starring Penelope

Cruz and John Hurt (plus hundreds of Cephalonian extras). The movie was filmed entirely on location in Cephalonia in 2000, largely in and around the town of Sami. Much of the town was requisitioned as the film set for several months, for which the locals were paid handsomely.

The film was not a major success, and met with brutal reactions from critics over its shortcomings, generating a controversy in online film databases. Over 200 reviews appeared on IMDB (the Internet Movie Database) and Amazon websites alone, discussing the virtues and pitfalls of John Madden's cinematic adaptation of the book. De Bernières himself refused to be associated with the movie, disappointed with Hollywood's decision to ditch the complexity of his historical narrative in favour of a simple love story. However, the film had a very positive impact for the island's tourism industry both during and after filming. The cinematic narrative invests in the Cephalonian landscape in a very suggestive way, and reviewer's references to the 'breathtaking' scenery and the depiction of Greek life are numerous. In a research article that analysed the adaptation of the novel, the author comments 'one wonders if the actual aim of this film is to advertise the beauty of the Cephalonian land.'⁴²

The film was made over four months between May and September 2000 and during the making of the film, Sami's 1000 beds were fully occupied, and many people came to watch the filming. Publicity shots featuring the two main stars (Cage and Cruz) were flashed around the world, raising the island's profile considerably. The couple allegedly had an affair, generating even more publicity, and a local woman still advertises her apartment as the location for the affair. Unfortunately, after filming, the set was destroyed and very little remains to remind visitors about the film. A solitary door behind the Kastro Hotel (the location of the main set) still has the words in Italian saying 'Keep Out Explosives.' But this is the only thing left from the set. Even a statue used in the movie was burned in 2003 because nobody could see a use for it.

The following year, in 2001, when the film was released, tourism numbers rose significantly. Initially tourists were disappointed after seeing the film and then visiting Sami hoping to marvel at its pretty Venetian architecture. Sami was largely reduced to rubble in a 1953 earthquake that devastated most of the island, and the town seen in the movie was a cleverly constructed set. But still film tourists flocked to the island, especially from the UK. Spiros Galiatsatos, president of the Hotel Association of Cephalonia said at the time, 'the film is a good love story and it shows the weather, the culture, the people and locally produced goods such as Cephalonia meat pie. Everyone who has seen the film will expect to find us to be friendly and warm people.'⁴³

Today, locals still have positive memories of the film. Denis Messoris from the Tourist Office in Argostoli says 'the film was good for everyone. They hired lots of extras (including many animals) and many Greeks from the mainland came to see Nicolas Cage and Penelope Cruz. We saw an increase of 15–20 percent in tourists in 2001 because of the film, and many tourism operators in Europe promoted Cephalonia using the film.' An example of the promotion he referred to happened in May 2001 when

Greek specialists Kosmar and East Midland Airport took 90 Midland travel agents to a special showing of the movie in order to promote the destination. Others used the cinematic landscape on their websites to promote sales of holidays to the island. For example, Tapestry Holidays used images from the film to decorate its website, and Calypso, a Greek tourist site, had a special web page under the title 'Filming of Captain Corelli puts Cephalonia on the tourist map.' A Greek Tourist Information site also invited visitors to book luxury village houses 'near where the true story of *Captain Corelli's Mandolin* was filmed.'

Table 1 shows the number of arrivals according to Airport statistics. In the year of filming (2000), visitor numbers to Cephalonia rose by 14 per cent, and in 2001 the island experienced a 16 per cent increase in charter traffic from over 137,000 to nearly 160,000. Numbers rose 6 per cent the following year, and 2003 arrivals remained the same as the previous year. In 2004, visitor numbers fell nearly 9 per cent to 154,822. The rise in numbers from Britain specifically, immediately following the film, was even more significant, with 2001 seeing a 22 per cent increase on the previous year, to 143,063, and a huge 37 per cent increase on

Table 1: Visitor arrivals to Cephalonia, 1999–2004

Origin of arrivals	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004
Austria	2998	2453	3186	2823	2314	2260
Czech Republic	2221	2608	2310	1781	4651	4348
Germany	1664	1008	1050	942	742	–
Ireland	–	–	–	–	2860	3212
Italy	–	–	–	–	132	–
Netherlands	1062	1479	1210	1059	1050	797
Slovenia	563	600	712	756	690	744
Sweden	3909	4589	4271	2863	1762	–
Denmark	1418	3174	1964	–	–	–
Norway	–	1558	1397	–	–	–
Finland	1766	2470	–	–	–	–
United Kingdom	104412	117375	143063	157171	154782	143461
Increase/Decrease	–	+12.4%	+22 %	+10 %	(1.52%)	(7.31%)
Other	–	–	–	1328	–	–
TOTAL	120013	137314	159163	168723	168983	154822
Increase/Decrease		+14%	+16%	+6%	+0.15%	(8.88%)

numbers before filming took place. In 2002 numbers rose about 10 per cent, but then declined slightly in 2003. In 2004 UK visitor numbers fell another 7.3 per cent to 143,461, back to similar numbers for 2001.

In order to attribute the increase in tourism arrivals to the exposure that the book and film gave Cephalonia, it is important to examine the numbers in relation to arrivals for Greece as a whole. A comparison of Table 1 and Table 2 shows that in the year of the filming (2000), arrivals to Cephalonia from the UK increased by slightly less than for Greece overall. However, in 2001 there was a 16 per cent increase in Cephalonia compared to a 7.3 per cent increase in tourists to Greece. During that year, visitor numbers from the UK to Greece overall rose by 5.8 per cent compared to a 21 per cent increase in UK visitors to Cephalonia. In 2002 cuts in capacity were made by many of the big tour operators on the larger islands of Corfu, Zante, Crete and Rhodes, and overall visitor numbers to Greece fell 0.8 per cent and from the UK numbers rose just 1.7 per cent. Cephalonia on the other hand continued to do well, showing a 6 per cent increase in overall tourist numbers, and an increase of nearly 10 per cent from the UK. These statistics would seem to suggest that *Captain Corelli's Mandolin* had a significant effect on tourism arrivals for Cephalonia, particularly from the UK.

Not all the Britons who came to see the 'island in the book' went home permanently and the romance of the place persuaded many to buy their own piece of Greece. An estimated 2000 British now have properties on Cephalonia and land values have increased 75 per cent since 2000. '*Captain Corelli's Mandolin* put the island on the map,'

said Linda Horton of Kefalonia4us, an estate agency based in Argostoli. Holiday prices to the island also rose as a result of the film. 'In Cephalonia, prices have rocketed over the past two years,' said Dudley der Parthog, director of tour operator Sunvil.

There were some concerns that mass tourism might spoil Cephalonia, but there was a determination among tourism officials that the fame the island enjoyed following the book and film did not spoil the peace and sophistication that regular visitors seek. Building has been strictly controlled, with nothing over two storeys allowed, and environmental protection is a top priority. In fact, many of the islanders were happy to see the film set destroyed and removed. As Doug Goodman, a former employee of the Hotel Association of Cephalonia said 'Cephalonians have learned from the mistakes made by other areas in Greece and plan to keep their island the way it is, while continuing to offer their traditional hospitality to everyone.'

However, there are many others who would like to have seen the tourism industry getting more involved with the film-makers to ensure there was something left for film tourists to visit. Amanda, a bar owner in Poros, said that 'initially there was lots of excitement generated by the film. Lots of celebrities came here the year the film was shot. But unfortunately, they took down the set so there is little for tourists to see now.' In Sami there is very little evidence of the filming of *Captain Corelli*. Only one or two people set up businesses related to the movie, one of them being the Captain Corelli Bar. However, according to locals, the bar has not been a success.

Panagis Kavelievatos owns a photo shop

Table 2: Arrivals to Greece (millions)

	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003
UK Arrivals to Greece	2.433	2.772	2.916	2.966	2.988
Increase/Decrease		+14%	+5.8%	+1.7%	(.74)%
Total Arrivals to Greece	12.164	13.095	14.033	13.917	13.886
Increase/Decrease		+7.6%	+7.3%	(0.8)%	(.22)%

that sells photographs from the making of the film. He says that

‘many people are still looking for a landmark from the film and they are disappointed when I tell them nothing remains. If I didn’t exist, there would be nothing. More tourists would come if there was something to see. I sell the same number of photographs each year, with the English being the main buyers. There wasn’t enough done to promote the filming of the movie in Cephalonia. There was no cooperation between the tourism industry, the locals and the film industry. I don’t think anyone understood or anticipated what the impact of the film could be. All everyone cared about was how much money they could make at the time of the movie.’

Aris from Island Car Rentals in Sami was employed as a construction worker before the film crew came in, and agrees with Kavelievatos:

‘From the beginning it was wrong. Everyone took something and ran. Nobody from the tourism industry was involved. Nicolas Cage was given US\$10m and the same amount was thrown at villagers for their cooperation. Everyone was paid off.’

He is upset that nothing remains of the film set:

‘They destroyed most of the set when they simulated battles and earthquakes, so there is nothing left. Many of the props, such as the war vehicles, were borrowed from collectors in Europe, and everything else was sold or taken by villagers. To be working on the set for four months and see it destroyed was depressing.’

He says that many people still ask him about the film, and it would be nice to send them to a landmark. ‘Many of the British construction workers who built the film set return year after year with their families, and many relatives of the Italian soldiers who died on the island come to the island, inspired by the making of the film,’ said Aris. In Cephalonia, between 1943 and 1944, more than 9000 Italians and approximately

300 Greeks lost their lives during the Second World War. Five thousand of these soldiers were mass executed by the Nazis. A small Museum and a Memorial Monument commemorate those who died.

IMPLICATIONS

It is clear from the case that both the book and the film of *Captain Corelli’s Mandolin* had a very positive impact on tourism visitation to Cephalonia, especially from the UK. It is likely that film tourists to Cephalonia were *specific film tourists* as categorized by Macionis, and motivated by all three pull factors – place, personality and performance.⁴⁴ The scenery of Cephalonia in the film was spectacular, the publicity surrounding the film’s stars was strong, and many tourists would have been inspired by the storyline of the book and film. However, the most powerful pull seemed to be ‘the place’. According to one commentator, reviews of the film ‘transformed the Cephalonian nature into the principal actor of the story.’⁴⁵ Cephalonia was represented in the film as an exotic, seaside resort, and this created a desire among viewers to visit the island. As Riley and Van Doren have suggested, the key for the construction of a favourable destination impression is a formula of idyllic or extraordinary landscape qualities, a unique social and cultural vantage point, and/or an image that tourists identify with and wish to explore.⁴⁶ The cinematic narrative of *Captain Corelli’s Mandolin* seems to have all of these qualities. For destination marketers, this is further evidence that films will have an impact on destination image if a location plays a prominent part in the film.

This case is interesting in that tourism visitation increased dramatically over the two-year period following release of the film, and yet the film was supposedly a box office failure, suggesting that film tourism is not always directly related to a film’s success. There is also some evidence to support the enduring aspects of film tourism,⁴⁷ as arrivals from the UK have remained higher than pre-film statistics, and many of the workers involved in the film return year after year

with their families, as do relatives of the Italian soldiers who died on the island in the Second World War. However, tourist arrivals did fall in 2004, suggesting that the film is no longer having such a strong influence on tourism in Cephalonia.

Perhaps what is even more interesting is that such a large number of film tourists visited the island despite almost no marketing activity on behalf of the island's DMO. The only organizations that appeared to leverage the film were UK tour operators, although one Greek Tourist Information website did mention the film. One can speculate that publicity generated by the media at the time of filming did have an impact on tourism, but there is no evidence that this was planned, either by the film company or the destination. These findings do not suggest that DMOs should ignore the marketing opportunities presented by film tourism. In fact, if Cephalonia tourist authorities had been more proactive, tourist numbers may have been even higher, and more sustainable. Previous research has highlighted the importance of having icons that can be a focal point for visitation,⁴⁸ but in the case of *Captain Corelli's Mandolin*, the set was destroyed, and there is nothing for film tourists to visit. There is also no evidence of any marketing cooperation between the destination and the film-makers, a fact alluded to by some of the locals.

In terms of impacts, there was certainly a short-term positive economic impact for the island, and many locals benefited financially from the filming. One could argue that this short-term outlook has prevented film tourism from being sustainable, and that Cephalonia is one of those destinations referred to earlier that has a short-term focus that facilitates film production only, concentrating on the associated economic impacts.⁴⁹ On the other hand, some officials on the island seemed to be aware of the potential drawbacks to film tourism and did not want to encourage mass tourism. As it was, land values increased 75 per cent as a result of the film, and holiday prices increased following the film. Another negative impact was that tourists were disappointed after seeing the film

and then visiting Sami hoping to marvel at its pretty Venetian architecture. It was mentioned earlier that a problem that could occur with film tourism is when the location appears different to how it is portrayed in the film, resulting in a loss of visitor satisfaction.⁵⁰ The town seen in the movie was a cleverly constructed set.

However, from the interviews with stakeholders in Cephalonia, the interviewer got the distinct impression that *Captain Corelli's Mandolin* was a missed marketing opportunity. Many tourism businesses consulted were suffering in the summer of 2004 – a number of them having opened just because of the increase in tourist numbers following the film. Perhaps it is not too late for Cephalonia to leverage the filming of *Captain Corelli* and sustain tourism arrivals. Grihault has noted that many destinations have redeveloped locations to make film connections more apparent, and boosted tourism even when the film is not new.⁵¹ Rebuilding the set would be one option for the island, but less-expensive marketing initiatives would be the production of a movie map, or the development of guided tours based on the film. Currently, a shop selling photographs from the film is not enough of an attraction to either lure film tourists to the island, or satisfy those who have made the pilgrimage because of the film or the book.

In conclusion, this case study has provided an illuminating view of the film tourism phenomenon. It has supported some of the theory previously developed in this area, and is further evidence of the powerful impact that films can have on destination image. The case has shown that film tourism is a complex and dynamic concept and success is dependent on a number of factors outside the control of a destination. Clearly further research is needed to examine these and other factors relating to film tourism. There is also a need for more research into the psychological and behavioural aspects of film tourism. Many variables may effect a film's impact on viewers' attitudes towards a destination and therefore on tourism. Reactions to these variables warrant further analysis.

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